

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

How to Talk to AI — improv tips, answer keys, what-ifs, the AI-honesty talk.



WHY THIS LESSON

A good AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains both, and it stands alone. Why a genie? Kids already know a wish gets twisted on a technicality, and a vague prompt fails the same way.

PLAYING THE WORST GENIE EVER

Three moves cover every wish: **take a word literally** ("rich" = a name), **fill the missing detail badly** (money = play money), or **grant it in the least useful form** (a hero story = "Once there was a hero. The end."). Stay cheerful — never mean, just literal. When a student adds a rule and you have to grant it properly, applaud it.

SAMPLE GENIE-PROOF REPAIRS (WORKSHEET P.1)

There is no single right answer — score with the Genie-Proof Checklist. Here are exemplars, each with the twist it blocks:

CURSED	EXEMPLAR REPAIR
Amara — "tell me about space" <i>Blocked twist: 40 pages on NASA</i>	"I'm a 7th grader making a one-page science poster about black holes, due Friday. Give me 5 amazing facts, each under 20 words, written so a 5th grader could get it. No math formulas."
Mateo — "help me save money" <i>Blocked twist: "Stop buying things."</i>	"I'm 12 and get \$15 a week. I want \$120 headphones in 10 weeks. Make a simple weekly savings plan as a table, and give 2 tips for not spending it on snacks."
Yuki — "make a story about a hero" <i>Blocked twist: a one-line story</i>	"Write the opening paragraph (max 100 words) of an anime-style story about a shy kid whose sketchbook drawings come to life. Keep the tone mysterious and end on a cliffhanger."

MODEL TWISTS (KEY FOR THE BREAK-IT PAGE)

A twist counts only if it obeys *every word* of the wish. Each exemplar rule blocks a twist: take the rule out, and the genie gets this. **Amara**: drop "under 20 words" → each fact is a page; drop "poster" → a 10-page report. **Mateo**: drop "in 10 weeks" → a 40-year plan, 6 cents a week; drop "simple" → a 30-column spreadsheet. **Yuki**: drop "max 100 words" → one sentence again; drop "anime-style" → a Western.

SCORING GUIDANCE (EACH REPAIR)

- **Proficient**: all three P.R.O. parts present and specific; partner-genie couldn't twist it.
- **Developing**: two parts, or vague ones ("make it short").
- **Beginning**: restated the cursed wish with more words.

✦ ANSWER KEY — WORKSHEET P.2 (BREAK IT + EXIT TICKET)

ITEM	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
Genie test row (✓ = genie-proof)	A ✓ is earned only if the partner tried a twist out loud and failed. Test against the exemplars: "5 facts under 20 words, no formulas" leaves nothing to twist; "some facts about space" can still become 40 pages. A ✓ on P, R, and O with no Genie-test ✓ is a fair score: the rules were there, just too loose.
Sneakiest twist (the DOK-3 item)	Compare with Model Twists (p.1). Strong: names the wish + the missing rule + the twisted result ("Wish 2 has no time limit, so: a 40-year plan"). Developing: a twist with no missing rule named. Redo: "make it weird" — a real twist obeys every word of the wish.
Exit #1 — prompt for another class	Exemplar: "I'm in 6th grade math learning fractions. Make me 5 practice problems on adding fractions with different denominators, easy to hard, with the answers on a separate line. No decimals." Part two (first five words: "I'm in 6th grade math"): a good answer names the twist, like "the genie would explain what 6th grade math is" or "it would give me random math with no fractions." Proficient = shows the SHORT prompt lets the genie choose. This item measures Objective 1.
Exit #2 — the black-hole answer	The one false claim: "Scientists took the first-ever photo of a black hole in 2009." The first image of a black hole (in galaxy M87, by the Event Horizon Telescope) came out in April 2019. Proficient: underlines that sentence AND names a real source (science textbook, NASA's website, a librarian, the school library database). Also proficient: underlines "even light can't escape" or "Giant black holes sit in the middle of most big galaxies" and names a real source. Both are true but checkable, and spotting a checkable claim is the skill. Developing: a sentence, no source. Not accepted: "I'd check it on AI."

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

Inappropriate wish → "The genie doesn't grant that one. Next wish." Don't repeat it or react.

A pair finishes Repair early → Extension (back of p.2): a wish that CAN'T be genie-proofed in under 50 words, and why. Model: "I wish for the best song ever." No rule pins down whose "best," so the genie picks.

Partner rubber-stamps every ✓ → Make them say the twist out loud. No twist? The ✓ stands. A twist? Cross out the Genie-test ✓ and write the twist.

Same repair three times → "What does Mateo need that Yuki doesn't?" A plan is not a story, so the O part has to change.

Odd number of students → One trio passes sheets to the left. Each genie scores one sheet and reads the twists to its owner.

"But the AI I use at home gets it right" → "Sometimes. Was that the AI reading your mind, or you getting lucky? Today we stop needing luck."

Live AI answer in the Showcase is bad → Best case. "Which part of the wish let it do that?" The class adds a rule. Run it again only if you have the minute.

Exit #2: "it all sounds right" → "Which sentence has a number or a date in it? Start there." Never put the key on the projector.

◆ THE AI-HONESTY DISCUSSION (USE ANYTIME IT COMES UP)

Q: "Is using AI cheating?" — One line does the work: *AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter*. Feedback, brainstorming, checking understanding = editor. Handing in its work with your name on it = ghostwriter. Ask: "What did YOU make?"

Q: "Is the AI always right?" — No. It predicts likely words, so it can be confidently wrong ("hallucinate"), like a trickster genie. The lesson's rule of thumb: *A name, a date, a number: if you can check it, check it somewhere real before you use it*. Quotes count too. (Lesson 3 in the unit, Hallucination Hunters, goes deep on this.)

Q: "Will AI take all the jobs?" — Say it straight: nobody knows yet. So far, AI mostly takes over tasks, not whole jobs. People who can direct an AI clearly and check what it hands back will likely have an edge. That's today's lesson.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: P.R.O. instruction (a prompt broken into Purpose / Requirements / Output). Assessed: the three wish repairs (worksheet p.1) and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the Scoring Guidance above.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: the trickster rule that opens the Exit Ticket block and the "Is the AI always right?" discussion. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 — students evaluate a printed sample AI answer, underline the sentence they would double-check, and name a real source to check it.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: the Purpose part (task + audience) and the Requirements part (style, length, tone). Assessed: wish repairs 1–3 + Exit Ticket #1.*

SUPPORT & ELL: P.R.O. SENTENCE STARTERS

P: "I am a ____ grader working on _____. I want ____ for _____."

R: "Keep it ____ (length). Use a ____ tone. Include _____. Do NOT _____."

O: "Give me the answer as a ____ (list / table / paragraph / steps)."

Support students may repair two wishes instead of three. ELL students may draft in their strongest language first, then translate — the starters double as language frames.

◆ THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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